COURSE SYLLABUS

Academic Year 2025 - 26, Semester – [Fall / Spring]

ENT 241 – Entrepreneurship 1

Suggested version · updated 1 November 2026 · for department review

1. COURSE INFORMATION

Course Title:	Entrepreneurship 1			
Course Code:	ENT 241			
Course Identity:	Analyze & Plan · Semester 3 of the ENT journey			
Course Credit:	2-0-2			
Contact Hours:	Lec [30 Hrs], Lab/Non-Lec [0 Hrs] Total: 30 Hrs (one 2-hour class weekly: lecture + in-class challenge)			
Course Pre-requisite(s):	ENT 142			
Course Co-requisite(s):	None			
Course Category:	University Requirement (GE):		Program Requirement:	✓
Course Type:	Compulsory:	✓	Elective:	

2. FACULTY INFORMATION

Instructor Name:	This section will be filled at the time of offering of course.
Lecture/Lab Timings:	
Office Location:	
Office Hours:	
E-mail:	
Office Telephone:	
Course Website:	Course Website on Moodle

3. COURSE DETAILS

3.1 Course Description

Entrepreneurship 1 is the third course of the CUD entrepreneurship pathway and the first of two Business courses (ENT 241–ENT 242). Building on the problem, evidence and tested MVP from ENT 141 and ENT 142, students analyse a commercial opportunity and plan a venture. They use the Value Proposition Canvas, PESTLE, Porter's Five Forces and SWOT to analyse the opportunity and its environment, compare business model types including franchising and licensing, build and redesign a Business Model Canvas, and plan marketing, capital, legal foundations, intellectual property, operations and risk. The course ends with a business plan reviewed at a Business Plan Clinic and an investor pitch. Each week is a 2-hour class that combines a short lecture with an in-class challenge.

3.2 Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) and Alignment to GE Learning Outcomes (GELOs)

On successful completion of this course, the student will be able to:

Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)		GELOs
CLO 1	Discuss Entrepreneurship issues related to Acquisition, Marketing, Strategic Growth, and	**1,5**

Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)		GELOs
	Exit Strategies.	
CLO 2	Demonstrate skills, or improvement on skills, that are needed to form effective (diverse) teams.	**2,3**
CLO 3	Develop a business proposition in a feasibility study using strategic tools.	**5,6,7**

4. TEACHING SCHEDULE

4.1 Lectures Schedule

Week No.	Topic Covered in Class	Class Activities	CLOs	Reference/ Course Material	Course Assessment *(Please specify if the assessment is out-of-class)*	
					Assignment Type	Due Date*
1	**Commercial Entrepreneurship & Opportunity**	• **Commercial Opportunity Hunt**: identify changes, problems and trends that could generate commercial opportunities; compare commercial and social ventures.	1	Burns (2022) Ch. 1&3, Okasha (2020) *		
2	**Opportunity Recognition & Idea Evaluation**	• **Recognition–Discovery–Creation Challenge**: analyse how opportunities emerge and apply prior idea-evaluation skills rather than reteaching them.	3	Burns (2022) Ch. 6; Ahmad et al. (2022)		
3	**Value Proposition Canvas**	• **Customer Jobs Detective**: map Jobs–Pains–Gains and distinguish evidence from assumptions.	3	Osterwalder et al. (2014); Burns (2022) Ch. 7		
4	**PESTLE & External Environment**	• **UAE PESTLE + Futures Thinking Challenge**: identify important trends, develop plausible future scenarios and identify entrepreneurial opportunities under each future.	3	Burns (2022) Ch. 5		
5	**Porter's Five Forces & SWOT**	• **Five Forces War Room**: students represent customers, suppliers, competitors, substitutes and new entrants; translate findings into SWOT implications.	2, 3	Burns (2022) Ch. 5	A1 Opportunity & environment analysis	Week 5
6	**Business Model Types**	• **Business Model Innovation Workshop**: compare direct sales, subscription, freemium, marketplace/platform, peer-to-peer, franchising, licensing and other models; explore how the same opportunity can operate under different	1	Osterwalder & Pigneur (2010)		

Week No.	Topic Covered in Class	Class Activities	CLOs	Reference/ Course Material	Course Assessment *(Please specify if the assessment is out-of-class)*	
					Assignment Type	Due Date*
		models.				
7	**Franchising, Licensing & Alternative Models**	• **Franchise Challenge**: analyse franchisor/franchisee roles, standardization, revenue/fees, resources, advantages and risks; compare franchising, licensing and independent growth.	1	Burns (2022) Ch. 7; instructor case pack		
8	**Business Model Canvas**	• **Human BMC Workshop**: nine BMC blocks around the classroom; teams physically move through them to construct and check their venture model.	2, 3	Osterwalder & Pigneur (2010)		
9	**Business Model Innovation & BMC Application**	• **Business Model Remix**: redesign the same venture using a different model (e.g. ownership → subscription, or traditional business → P2P/platform) and compare value creation and capture.	1, 3	Osterwalder & Pigneur (2010); Antonio et al. (2023)	A2 Business model pack	Week 9
10	**Product Development & Marketing Strategy**	• **First 10 Customers Challenge**: create a realistic strategy for acquiring the venture's first 10 customers, including product, positioning, channel and promotion.	1,3	Burns (2022) Ch. 9		
11	**Capital, Legal Foundations & Intellectual Property**	• **Protect Your Venture Workshop**: identify applicable trademark, copyright, patent/design protection and trade-secret considerations; connect IP to competitive advantage and commercialization.	1, 3	Burns (2022) Ch. 11 & 15		
12	**Open Innovation, Operations & Risk**	• **Open vs. Closed Innovation Challenge**: decide when to develop internally or collaborate with customers, suppliers, universities, startups or partners. Startup Pre-Mortem: 'It is three years later and the venture failed. Why?'	1,3	Burns (2022) Ch. 12 & 13; Chesbrough (2003)		
13	**Business Plan Development**	• **Business Plan Clinic**: peer and expert review stations for Market / Business	1, 2, 3	Burns (2022) Ch. 17	A3 Business plan	Week 13

Week No.	Topic Covered in Class	Class Activities	CLOs	Reference/ Course Material	Course Assessment *(Please specify if the assessment is out-of-class)*	
					Assignment Type	Due Date*
		Model / Marketing / Operations / Finance / Risk.				
14	**Investor Pitch Technique**	• **Investor Readiness Workshop + Question Roulette**: rehearse the pitch and answer unpredictable investor questions about assumptions, market, model and finance.	2	van Werven et al. (2019)		
15	**Investor Pitch**	• **Business Model / Investor Challenge**: pitch to external entrepreneurs or investors where possible. Panel response: Invest / Need More Evidence / Pass, followed by developmental feedback.	2, 3	van Werven et al. (2019)	A4 Investor pitch	Week 15

4.2 Lab/ Non-Lecture Schedule

Not Applicable

5. TEACHING PEDAGOGY

The course is taught as one 2-hour class each week (2-0-2). The class opens with a short lecture on one concept from the textbook, with UAE examples, and continues with one in-class challenge (Section 4.1) in which teams apply the tool to their own venture. Teams of 4–5 keep one venture from Week 1 to the investor pitch and carry it into ENT 242.

Some classes may include a short contribution from a practising entrepreneur, an investor or a CUD Incubator partner, within the scheduled class time; this does not add contact hours and does not replace the lecture or the in-class challenge.

Students are encouraged to take part in business-plan competitions, hackathons and incubator programmes at CUD and UAE level.

Inclusive learning: Materials follow Universal Design for Learning: templates, short steps and sentence starters for every in-class challenge, and students may show their learning in writing, speaking or visuals. Individual adjustments follow CUD's student-support process.

6. TEXTBOOK/REFERENCE BOOK/COURSE MATERIAL

Textbooks (TB):

a. Burns, P. (2022). Entrepreneurship and Small Business: Start-up, Growth and Maturity (5th ed.). Red Globe Press. ISBN 978-1-352-01249-1.

Reference Books (RB):

a. Osterwalder, A., & Pigneur, Y. (2010). Business Model Generation. Wiley.
b. Osterwalder, A., Pigneur, Y., Bernarda, G., & Smith, A. (2014). Value Proposition Design: How to Create Products and Services Customers Want. Wiley.

Suggested Readings (SR):

a. Ahmad, N. A., Rasul, M. S., Othman, N., & Jalaludin, N. A. (2022). Generating entrepreneurial ideas for business development. Sustainability, 14, 4905. https://doi.org/10.3390/su14094905
b. Antonio, J. L., Schmidt, A. L., Kanbach, D. K., & Meyer, N. (2023). Enacting disruption: How entrepreneurial ventures innovate value propositions to increase the attractiveness of their technologies. International Journal of Entrepreneurial Behavior & Research.
c. Chesbrough, H. (2003). Open Innovation: The New Imperative for Creating and Profiting from Technology. Harvard Business School Press.
d. Okasha, A. A. (2020). Entrepreneurship in the United Arab Emirates. In Entrepreneurial innovation and economic development in Dubai and comparisons to its sister cities (pp. 158–182). IGI Global.
e. van Werven, R., Bouwmeester, O., & Cornelissen, J. P. (2019). Pitching a business idea to investors: How new venture founders use micro-level rhetoric to achieve narrative plausibility and resonance. International Small Business Journal, 37(3), 193–214.

7. LEARNING RESOURCES

Course website on Moodle contains class announcements, lecture notes, in-class challenge templates, assignments and submission links. Online materials support the classes; they do not replace classes, attendance or class activities.

8. COURSE ASSESSMENT AND EVALUATION

The information concerning the appropriate distribution of grade weight amongst various assessment items and their corresponding linkage with the stated CLOs is provided in the following table.

Assessment Items		Grade Weight (%)	Course Learning Outcomes (CLOS)		
			1	2	3
A1	Opportunity & environment analysis (Week 5)	25			✓
A2	Business model pack (Week 9)	25	✓		✓
A3	Business plan (Week 13)	25	✓	✓	✓
A4	Investor pitch (Week 15)	25		✓	✓

9. ASSESSMENT METHODOLOGY

Four assignments of 25%, one after each block of study. Each one is built in the in-class challenges, so students work on it with the instructor present. Teams of 4–5 keep the same venture across ENT 241 and ENT 242; individual marks come from individual questions and peer evaluation.

A1 – Opportunity & environment analysis (Team, Week 5, 25%): For one commercial opportunity: a Value Proposition Canvas built from evidence, a UAE PESTLE with one future scenario, Porter's Five Forces and the SWOT implications. Built in the Week 1–5 challenges; up to 1500 words with the canvases.

A2 – Business model pack (Team, Week 9, 25%): A Business Model Canvas for the venture and one redesigned alternative (for example subscription, platform, franchise or licensing), comparing how

each creates and captures value. Built in the Human BMC Workshop and the Business Model Remix.

A3 – Business plan (Team, Week 13, 25%): A business plan of up to 3000 words: opportunity and value proposition, market and industry analysis, business model, marketing and the first 10 customers, capital and funding, legal foundations and IP, operations, risks and pre-mortem, growth and exit options, milestones. Reviewed at the Business Plan Clinic before submission; each member submits a peer evaluation.

A4 – Investor pitch (Team pitch, individual Q&A, Week 15, 25%): A pitch of up to 8 minutes to a panel (the instructor, with external entrepreneurs or investors where possible), followed by individual questions on assumptions, market, model and finance. Panel response: Invest / Need More Evidence / Pass, with feedback that carries into ENT 242.

Note: A student will lose 10% or more for non-compliance with group efforts (teamwork) and failing to meet tutor deadlines. No late project will be accepted. Exceptions for late evaluation are up to the discretion of the instructor.

10. COURSE REQUIREMENTS AND POLICIES

The students are required to fully understand and observe the following policies of the university.

10.1 Attendance Policy

Attending classes is compulsory in all courses. CUD Students will not be allowed to take the final examination if they are absent for 25% or more of the classes in a course. (Students should refer to their respective Department or School/Faculty for additional specific program-related information.)

a. When a student has been absent for 10% of the course an absence reminder would be sent by email.
b. When a student has been absent for 20% of the course a second absence reminder would be sent by e-mail
c. When a student has been absent for 25% of the course a notice of Failure for Non-Attendance will be sent by email and grade “FA” with Grade Point of 0.0 will be awarded.

A student with a verifiable and legitimate reason for missing a class (e.g., hospitalization) may request his instructor not to count such an absence towards the 25%. Such excusable absences must be noted in the Course File Attendance Report.

Should an acceptable explanation for a student’s absenteeism be available, the Dean/Designated Representative of the Faculty concerned may consider the student’s withdrawal without penalty from the particular course. A withdrawal without penalty or any other alpha grade under these circumstances may only be considered with the consent of the Registrar.

10.2 Incomplete Work Policy

Students whose course work is at a passing level but who for verifiable reasons beyond their control are unable to finish course work by the end of a term (or the specified end of a course) may be granted a grade of "Incomplete".

The “I” is not intended to be a permanent grade. It is only a temporary acknowledgment of a legitimate reason for granting a one-time, limited extension to the time normally allowed to complete all course requirements.

Students have up to 12 calendar months after the scheduled end of the course to complete required additional work as determined by the teacher who assigned the "I", and to thereby qualify for a passing grade.

After 12 calendar months, outstanding "I" grades are converted to "F".

Thereafter, the student must repeat the course in order to achieve a passing grade.

The number of "Incomplete" courses allowed per semester is established by the School. Please contact the School for further information.

NOTE: An Incomplete grade for a pre-requisite course must be completed before the student is allowed to proceed to the higher-level course unless otherwise approved by the appropriate Academic Administrator (Dean or Designate).

10.3 Academic Integrity

Cheating refers to attempting or using unauthorized materials or obtaining unauthorized assistance in an academic activity, including all types of examinations or evaluations. This may include impersonating another student; looking at another student's materials; using unauthorized notes/books/calculators; talking to other students; using communication devices such as mobile phones or any Bluetooth devices.

Plagiarism includes, but is not limited to, representation of others' work, lending unauthorized assistance, and using strategies or processes with the aim of attaining dishonest grades on tests or examinations. Students may not submit any material created by or acquired from another person or business. Plagiarizing any type of course work will not be tolerated. All instances of plagiarizing shall be documented, presented to the Head/Dean of the program and to the Registrar, and recorded in the student's file. The maximum permissible similarity index limit is 20% for the assignments required to be submitted through Turnitin.

Any violation of the academic integrity policy is a serious offence which will be sanctioned as per the Academic Integrity Policy published in the Student Handbook. Please refer to the Catalogue for further information on student Academic Integrity.

11. GRADING SYSTEM

The University uses the relative grading system which is based on a four-point scale. An overall grade will be assigned on the following grading scale.

Percentage Score	Alpha Grade	GPA Points	Percentage Score	Alpha Grade	GPA Points
90-100	A+	4.0	60-64	C	2.0
80-89	A	3.8	55-59	D+	1.5
75-79	B+	3.5	50-54	D	1.0
70-74	B	3.0	0-49	F	0.0
65-69	C+	2.5			

The students must also read and comprehend the full version of the "Grading System" of the University which is published in the relevant Catalogue.

12. GRADING RUBRICS FOR ASSESSED ELEMENTS

Grading Rubric for A1: Opportunity & environment analysis (25 marks)

Criteria	Poor Level	Acceptable Level	Excellent Level

Value Proposition Canvas from evidence (7 marks)	Incomplete or guessed.	Canvas complete; little evidence.	Jobs, pains and gains backed by evidence; assumptions marked.
UAE PESTLE and future scenario (6 marks)	Generic or missing.	Trends listed; scenario weak.	Relevant UAE trends and one plausible scenario with its opportunity.
Five Forces and SWOT (7 marks)	Tools not applied.	Forces listed; implications thin.	Each force rated and turned into SWOT implications.
Clarity and sources (5 marks)	Unclear; no sources.	Mostly clear; few sources.	Clear, concise, APA references.

Grading Rubric for A2: Business model pack (25 marks)

Criteria	Poor Level	Acceptable Level	Excellent Level
Business Model Canvas (8 marks)	Blocks missing or contradictory.	Blocks complete; some do not fit.	All nine blocks consistent with each other and the evidence.
Alternative model (7 marks)	No alternative.	Alternative described superficially.	A real redesign (e.g. platform, franchise) that works.
Value creation and capture (6 marks)	No comparison.	Comparison partly made.	Clear comparison of value, costs and revenue in both.
Choice and justification (4 marks)	No choice.	Choice stated, weak reason.	Chosen model justified with evidence.

Grading Rubric for A3: Business plan (25 marks)

Criteria	Poor Level	Acceptable Level	Excellent Level
Market and industry analysis (6 marks)	Assumed or missing.	Analysis present; few sources.	Size, customers and competitors with sources.
Business model, marketing and first 10 customers (6 marks)	Unrealistic or missing.	Plan generic in places.	Realistic plan linked to the model.
Capital, legal and IP (5 marks)	Not covered.	Partly covered.	Funding needs, legal route and IP protection explained.
Operations, risk, growth and exit (5 marks)	Not covered.	Some risks; little mitigation.	Pre-mortem risks with mitigation; growth and exit options.
Writing and teamwork (peer evaluation) (3 marks)	Poor writing or no contribution.	Some errors; uneven contribution.	Professional, referenced; fair contribution.

Grading Rubric for A4: Investor pitch (25 marks)

Criteria	Poor Level	Acceptable Level	Excellent Level
Problem, solution and market (7 marks)	Unclear.	Clear but thin on evidence.	Clear, evidence-based, investor-focused.
Business model	Not shown.	Model shown; numbers	How the venture makes

and finance (6 marks)		vague.	money, with key numbers.
Delivery and visuals (5 marks)	Unprepared.	Over time or unclear in places.	On time, confident, clear slides.
Individual Q&A (7 marks)	Cannot answer.	Partial answers.	Precise answers on assumptions, market, model and finance.

13. VERIFICATION

(i) I verify that the contents of this document are up to date.

Instructor's Name and Signature Date

(ii) I have reviewed this course syllabus and state that it complies with CUD policies and guidelines.

_____ _____

Name and Signature of Department Chair/Program Coordinator Date

Note: *This page of the course syllabus is only for the purpose of documentation and therefore it should not be distributed to the students.*